development teams of all sizes with the flexibility to scale compute power at a very granular level, seamlessly collaborate on source code and shared APIs, and manage app performance, logs and costs from a single dashboard.

AWS IoT *(aws.amazon.com/iot/):* AWS IoT is a platform that enables you to connect devices to AWS services and other devices, secure data and interactions, process and act upon device data, and enables applications to interact with devices even when they are offline.

It provides an SDK, which can enable the writing of applications that connect devices all the way up to hosting the data, as well as writing applications that can utilise the data for workflow and analytics.

Azure IoT *(http://www.microsoft.com/en-in/server-cloud/internet-of-things/azure-iot-suite.aspx):* The Azure IoT Suite is an offering from Microsoft designed to get customers started quickly, and to realise business value from IoT. It can be up and running with a fully functional preconfigured solution in a matter of minutes, and can provide a set of 'virtual devices' that run in the cloud to visualise the entire solution, working end-to-end, without having to connect a physical device. Azure IoT Suite also takes care of the tasks of deploying and orchestrating the various services.

Azure IoT device SDK is an open source set of client libraries that run on a variety of operating systems and devices. The SDK also provides step-by-step guidance and sample code, which makes it easy to build prototypes with real devices that interact with the Azure IoT Suite.

With the Microsoft Azure IoT Suite, one can monitor assets to improve efficiencies, drive operational performance to enable innovation, and employ advanced data analytics to transform the company with new business models and revenue streams.

Azure IoT also offers specific solutions for energy, transportation, smart cities, manufacturing and healthcare.

OpenSensors.io: OpenSensors is an Internet of Things company providing public and private infrastructure for real-time data. It aims to make it easy for people to connect, deploy and remotely manage large deployments of sensors and Internet-connected devices in the field at scale, making it easy to create smart products. The company also provides the means to subscribe to and reuse publicly available real-time data. From PCs to Raspberry Pis, Android to Electric Imp, the platform is completely hardware-agnostic. Anyone can connect one or many devices and publish open data through OpenSensors for free, using the messaging broker. Open data is publicly accessible, shareable and reusable by anyone. You can search for public data such as earthquakes, transport and air quality easily. Users can also choose to keep their data private for monthly paid subscriptions.

OpenSensors is backed by 'Open Data Institute' whose founders are Sir Tim Berners-Lee (the inventor of the World Wide Web) and Sir Nigel Shadbolt (Principal of Jesus College at Oxford in the UK). ODI is an independent, non-profit, non-partisan company. It plays a key role in the development of smart cities, agriculture, nutrition and other projects in the UK and other parts of world.

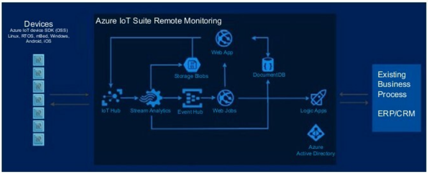

Figure 9: Microsoft Azure IoT – Copyright Microsoft

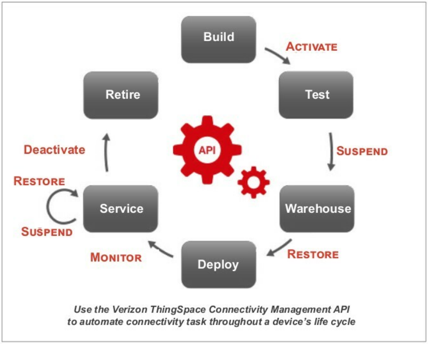

Figure 10: Verizon Thingspace Life cycle – Copyright Verizon